

1.3 Embedded styles

The idea behind embedded styles is that you still have your styles in the same HTML document, but grouped together in the head of the document as a single element which is gets applied page wide.

Let's try it out,

1. Open `embedded.html` in your text editor.
2. Within the `<head>` section of the template, just after the `<title>` element, paste the following code: `<style type="text/css">p {color: red;}</style>`
3. Again, we are using a simple CSS declaration to render the text red.
4. Save the template, and open it in the web browser.

Notice now that the text contained within both the paragraphs will be red. This time around, all paragraphs in the document are affected by this declaration, as the style is applied to all `<p>` tags within the page.

This method is definitely more effective than inline CSS and it allows you to administer styles throughout the document. But grouping the styles together within the HTML document still increases your file size. The problem with embedded styles is again the fact that they are loading from within the document. Also, these styles will be downloaded again and again every time with every page load, every page of your web site will need its own embedded styles, and making site-wide style changes will be very laborious.

1.4 External styles

The most commonly used method for implementing CSS and also the most effective is making use of external style sheets.

Again let us work with an example

1. Open `external.html` in your text editor.
2. Within the `<head>` section, and after the `<title>` element, paste the element `<link rel="stylesheet" type="text/css" href="external.css" />` and save the file. This line tells the browser to look for an external file called `external.css`, which is a CSS file, and is stored in the same directory as the HTML file.
3. Now create a new file called `external.css`.
4. Paste the following code `p {color: red;}` into `external.css`.
5. Save `external.css` to the same folder as the `.html` files, and again open it in your web browser.

Again the paragraphs turn red, but note that there is not a single CSS rule or style element anywhere in your HTML file. Your HTML is free from